

Gift and Entertainment Acceptance Policy

The acceptance of gifts and entertainment from vendors is an important aspect of our business relationships, as it can impact our perception of fairness and impartiality. As described under the Independent Contractor Classification Policy, we must ensure that all interactions with vendors are conducted in a manner that complies with applicable laws and regulations. When receiving gifts or entertainment from vendors, it is essential to maintain a professional demeanor and avoid any appearance of impropriety.

As a general rule, gifts from vendors valued over \$100 must be reported to the Compliance department for review and approval. This includes gifts such as cash, gift cards, or other items of value that exceed the specified threshold. It is crucial to note that cash or cash-equivalent gifts of any value are strictly prohibited, as they can create an appearance of impropriety and may be subject to reporting requirements under the Anti-Kickback Act. As described under the Software License Compliance Policy, we must ensure that all software licenses and agreements comply with applicable laws and regulations, including those related to gift and entertainment.

When accepting gifts or entertainment from vendors, it is essential to maintain accurate records of the transaction, including the value of the gift and any relevant documentation. These records should be stored in a secure location and made available for review by Compliance upon request. Additionally, employees must ensure that they do not accept gifts or entertainment that could create an appearance of impropriety or favoritism towards specific vendors or customers.

It is also important to note that the acceptance of gifts or entertainment from vendors can impact our relationships with other stakeholders, including competitors and regulatory agencies. As such, it is essential to maintain a high level of professionalism and integrity in all business interactions, regardless of whether gifts or entertainment are involved. By following this policy and maintaining accurate records, we can ensure that our business relationships remain fair, impartial, and compliant with applicable laws and regulations.